

Welcome to Hope Sabbath School—an in-depth interactive study of the Word of God. We are continuing a series on Letters to New Christians. Today's topic: **ALL TO THE GLORY OF GOD.**

**Intro:** The title of our study today comes from 1 Corinthians 10:31.

**1) A steppingstone or a stumbling block**

- a. 1 Corinthians 8:1-13 How could eating meat offered to idols be a stumbling block to those who are weak?
- b. What motivated Paul to refrain from eating meat offered to idols? (Matthew 22:37-39)
- c. How was Paul's life a steppingstone rather than a stumbling block? 1 Corinthians 9:1-12,13-18,19-23
- d. Think of some individuals during the earthly ministry of Jesus whose lives were stumbling blocks rather than steppingstones. Caiaphas, Judas, Peter (at certain times), James and John (at certain times).
- e. What are some activities you might choose to avoid that might be a stumbling block to others?
- f. How can our lives be steppingstones, helping others on their journey toward a life-changing relationship with God? (Matthew 5:14-16, 25:34-36, etc.)

**2) Learning from the past**

- a. 1 Corinthians 10:1-11 What lessons can we learn from the experiences of the children of Israel in their wilderness wanderings from Egypt to Canaan?
- b. What word of caution did Paul give that will help us avoid similar failures? 1 Corinthians 10:12

- c. What word of hope did Paul give when we are tempted to repeat the mistakes of the past? 1 Corinthians 10:13
- d. Share a time when you felt spiritually weak and God made a way of escape for you.
- e. 1 Corinthians 10:14-22 The children of Israel were lured into idolatry. Christians in Corinth were tempted to return to idolatry. What warnings about idolatry would Paul give if he were here today?

**3) Do all to the glory of God**

- a. 1 Corinthians 10:31 What is the context for this life-principle Paul shared with Christians in Corinth?
- b. What motivated Paul to do all to the glory of God? 1 Corinthians 10:32-33
- c. Share some other aspects of life where this principle can be applied.
- d. Share a time when you were impressed to change your behavior because you realized that you could not continue this conduct to the glory of God.
- e. How does the invitation Paul given in 1 Corinthians 11:1 relate to the life-principle he shared in 1 Corinthians 10:31?
- f. How is God impressing you to apply this life-principle to your life today?

